



Asus's 1080p Eee PC

Asus's Eee PC 1015PN is now confirmed and will be powered by a dual core Atom processor to dish out full 1080p HD content

Stanford's test

Google is beta testing their high speed 1 Gbps fiber internet service at Stanford's residential subdivision

Important results

- 1) Sony has gained a slightly better footing in the market, while LG and Samsung seem to remain right where they were last year in terms of overall trust. This is probably because Sony cut prices this year. This gives them a competitive edge, as traditionally Sony has always been perceived as a costlier brand.
- 2) Sony takes a very strong lead in credibility. They had a 25 per cent higher level of trust in their brand, followed by Samsung. Sony's HDTVs were also rated as being at least 30 per cent more durable than those of other brands. This we feel, has less to do with the actual quality of build, and more a brand perception.
- 3) Sony also emerged a clear winner in the loyalty stake; 30 per cent more people who buy a Sony TV, tend to stick with Sony, and recommend it to others. Samsung follows in second spot, while LG trails to take third.
- 4) Panasonic has gained three points in terms of overall trust, whereas VU, Sharp and Hitachi have maintained last years level of trust with almost no growth in our survey.
- 5) Results for innovation: Sony and Samsung were the first and second choice, respectively, with around 8 points separating them. LG is a distant third. Samsung was the first to introduce LED TVs and 3D TVs to India. We feel these two elements might have played an important part in the perception.
- 6) Sony enjoys a 195 per cent lead over LG from the responses we got about display quality – rather shocking. Even Samsung enjoys a massive 145 percent lead over LG. This might have something to do with the fact that Samsung uses PVA panels that are known to produce deeper blacks and generally enjoy a better contrast ratio. And, we should add, that our tests have shown that such a big difference is not warranted. Looks like LG needs to improve their customer perception, more than their displays.

The most trusted

Sony has done it again, holding on to their top spot by a small margin. Samsung is the next most popular brand among our readers, garnering the second highest number of votes for reliability, trust, performance, innovation, after sales, longevity, features and quality. LG is a close number three.

DIGITAL CAMERAS

Now considered a necessity, digital cameras are a product category that really heats up in the festive season. Arguably one of the most important categories of all, for these little devices capture memories that are irreplaceable – bad photographs haunt you for life. There are a number of smaller brands that have emerged as players, offering competitive prices. A digital camera is also one of the few devices that one can actually grow out of. For example, someone buying a cheap point-n-shoot may upgrade to an ultra zoom later, or even to a digital SLR camera.

Market watch

We're slowly seeing a second wave of penetration for cameras happening in India, as first timers continue to purchase cameras. Meanwhile megapixels continue to grow, with no seeming heed paid to noise ratios of sensors. The feature sets also continue to expand, and we're seeing models with optical zooms of up to 35x emerge.

Ultra compacts are getting smaller, and more powerful, even as video is emerging as a competitive feature. dSLR cameras also continue to get cheaper, and today, a dSLR with lens can be had for the same price as some higher end ultra zooms. New models have been launched by most big players, and the others have followed suit, evidently anticipating a good boost in sales this holiday season.

Important results

- 1) 23 per cent of our respondents have purchased a digital camera in the past year; 53 per cent of them in the last two years. This tells us that barring cell phones, digital cameras are the hottest consumer electronics equipment around amongst our readers.
- 2) Most people know about Sony or Canon cameras without being aided.
- 3) Canon is perceived to be the most rugged brand, trailed closely by Sony, and then comes Nikon.
- 4) It's almost a tie between Canon and Sony when it comes to who has the technological edge.
- 5) When it comes to style, it's Sony all the way. Nearly 40 per cent more people feel Sony makes stylish cameras. Kudos to Sony's marketing team for their success in maintaining this image. Fujifilm and Kodak got the lowest votes here.
- 6) One important victory for Canon is their after sales service. People felt Canon is more responsive, and their

